

The Noble Vajrapāṇi, Wearer of the Dark Blue Garment, Vajrapātāla Tantra

Ārya-Vajrapāṇi-nīlāmbara-dhara-vajrapātāla-nāma-tantra · Toh 499 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཕགྱ་ན་རྫོལ་ཐོག་པའི་གཞི་ཅན་རྫོལ་གྱི་ཞལ་མདེ་ཁང་ཞེས་བ་བྱའི་རིན་པོ་ལུ།

Toh 499 in the Kangyur is a Buddhist tantra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Vajrapāṇi-nīlāmbara-dhara-vajrapātāla-nāma-tantra and in Tibetan as "The Tantra Called 'The Noble Vajrapāṇi, Wearer of the Dark Blue Garment, Vajrapātāla.'" It is a Vajrayāna tantric text centered on the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the powerful wielder of the thunderbolt who serves as a protector of the Buddhist teachings, and its narrative unfolds in the underground realm of the nāga kings, where the Buddha transmits esoteric instructions. The text belongs to the tantra section of the Kangyur and was translated into Tibetan by the Kashmiri paṇḍita Tselu together with the Tibetan translator known as the noble Śerab. The opening of the surviving Tibetan text begins at what is labeled the thirteenth chapter, suggesting this may be a partial or later portion of a larger tantric cycle.

This is the thirteenth chapter, which settles the secret.

Translated by the Kashmiri paṇḍita Tselu and the Tibetan translator, the noble Śerab.

In the language of India:
Ārya-Vajrapāṇi-nīlāmbara-dhara-vajrapātāla-nāma-tantra.

In the Tibetan language: The Tantra Called "The Noble Vajrapāṇi, Wearer of the Dark Blue Garment, Vajrapātāla."

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was seated upon a precious throne in the realm of the nāga king at the seventh level below the earth, together with the nāga kings Nandopananda, Kulika, and other nāgas, and with the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi and others.

Then from the right foot of the Blessed One he released innumerable hundreds of thousands of rays of light, and as these transformed throughout the world and omens appeared, the worldly beings became afraid and terrified and fell unconscious. The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi then beseeched the Blessed One, asking: "What is the cause and condition of this transformation of these rays of light and of these omens that have appeared?" The Blessed One declared:

"This arises from an immeasurable accumulation of merit, and so its fruit, too, is immeasurable. Please, awaken those bodhisattvas who have fainted." Thereupon the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi released innumerable hundreds of thousands of rays of light from his heart center, and by the mere touch of that light he raised those who had fainted.

Then the worldly beings uttered this exclamation in verse:

How wondrous! By the compassion of the great Sage,
when all the world had fallen into a swoon,
through the rays of great compassion
all those who had fainted were revived.

Then the worldly beings gathered at the realm of the nāga king at the seventh level below the earth and offered this supplication in verse:

O Teacher, Blessed One, Vajradhara,
whose enlightened body, speech, and mind perform their deeds,
for the benefit of all beings in the world
please teach the stainless teachings.

Then the Blessed One spoke the words: "Vajra abhiṣiṅca Vajrapāṇi hūṃ," and thereby made them proper vessels.

At that point the nāga kings became agitated. Greatly disturbed in mind, they shook their hoods and struck their chests, crying: "Alas! Our nāga realm and our Teacher have been seized by worldly beings — let these worldly beings be destroyed!" And so with the breath from their mouths they sent the disease of leprosy upon the worldly beings.

Then the Blessed One entered the meditative absorption called "Dispelling Disease," and from the jeweled symbol upon his heart center, together with the mantra "Vajradya," a ray of disease-dispelling light emerged from his mouth and shot forth like a reflection flashing across a mirror. The nāga kings then urged their nāga servants to attack, and some entered through the veins, some entered through the sense faculties, and some entered through the bones. Against those who entered through the veins, the Blessed One entered the meditative absorption of breath blazing like tongues of fire and burned them with his breath. Those who had entered through the sense faculties and through the bones he crushed with a wheel of fire.

At that the nāga kings became even more violently agitated; yet, severing their own luminous appearances one by one before the Blessed One himself,

and wrapping themselves around his body while retaining the awakening mind, they became his ornaments.

Then the nāga kings offered this verse of praise:

Though the nāga kings are mighty in this world,
they cannot withstand even a single hair-pore of the Blessed One.
Therefore the nāga kings shall always praise
the Blessed One, protector of all beings.

This concludes the first chapter, the introductory chapter, from the Vajrapātāla Tantra.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi prostrated to Vajradhara again and again and offered this supplication:

Those who have been made poor through the power of miserliness —
how may wealth be accomplished?
Before oneself, in the right hand of Vajrapāṇi,
the wisdom being Jambhala is to be visualized.
One recites, oneself, the king of mantras.
By rays of light at the heart
the wisdom being is to be invoked.
Visualize that the wisdom being himself
is the very one reciting the mantra of Jambhala.
From the heart of the wisdom being
light arises and invokes Jambhala.
The ocean of wealth shall become full.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi offered this supplication to Vajradhara:

Concerning very subtle faults
committed for the sake of fame and gain —
those things that harm and obstruct the world —
please teach how hail is to be averted.

First, erect a blue stūpa
and consecrate it in accordance with the proper texts.
Below it, draw a wheel
with eight spokes and a hub.

On the spokes, write the heart-syllables of the gods and demons:
Khāmṛdha, Cchāṅgha, Cchārṅgha, Śhārṅgha, Oṃdha, Mhorḍha, Thāoṃṛdha,
Sbhardha.

In the center, draw the mantra-master.
Then place this inside a skull.
Press the skull beneath the stūpa.
By the light of the heart-essence, summon
the mantra-master together with the gods, demons, and their retinues.
Strike them with ritual sessions.

When spirits are in turmoil,
one who bears the pride of the Teacher —
from the thumb onto the little finger,
from the syllable hūṃ, Vajrapāṇi is generated.
From the heart of the Vajrapāṇi on the little finger,
emit a Vajrapāṇi
holding a lasso and an iron hook.
With the iron hook of the heart, draw them in,
and with the lasso bind their throats.
From the thumb, from the vajra of Vajrapāṇi,
emit vajras.
Pierce the obstructors with them.
From each hair-pore vajras radiate forth.
All of space is accomplished as vajra.
Generate white mustard seeds as vajras and scatter them.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, having made offerings and prostrations to
Vajradhara, uttered this exclamation:

How wondrous! O Teacher, Vajradhara,
for the benefit of sentient beings
you have taught the warding off and the subsequent holding —
how marvelous! Liberation from poverty and the realm of hungry ghosts.

This concludes the second chapter of the Vajrapātāla Tantra, on accomplishing
wealth from the lower tantra and averting harm.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, having made offerings and prostrations to
Vajradhara, offered this supplication:

How are the leprosy and hail-water of nāgas, yakṣas, and earth-lords to be
averted?

Then the great king Vajradhara spoke these words in reply:

Sūtras cannot reverse the karmic maturation of actions, but mantras can avert it — and that is what makes them supremely excellent.

Now, as for what is called a nāga: it is a being whose afflictions are predominantly delusion, along with strong attachment and aversion as well. Through the power of delusion it sleeps a great deal. Through the power of aversion it does not release a person for seven lifetimes. Through the power of attachment, having entered a body that dwells in attachment, it does not let go. A nāga of the outcaste variety causes illness by mere sight. Three classes of nāga cause illness by mere touch. Nāga servants enter through the three upper gates and consume the vital essence of the body.

The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi asked: How are these to be tamed?

Then the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "summoning nāgas" and recited this mantra:

Nāga vidāraṇā jaḥ. Nāga utsādanaya jaḥ.

One who is well established in the three trainings
will summon them in a fearsome form.

Then the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "taming nāgas" and from his own breath drew forth these mantras:

Tadyathā: buddha buddha, vibuddha vibuddha, māti kramath, hara hara
nāgānāṃ, prahara prahara nāgānāṃ, chinda chinda nāgaḥṛdayāni —

bhinda bhinda nāgamarmmāṇi viṣīryantu nāgaśarīrāṇi, visfoṭaya
nāganāyanāni —

May they tremble with terror and fall senseless.

By meditating on the syllable HŪṂ at the heart,
all the nāgas are consumed by fire
and are reborn in the realm of bliss.

The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi asked: There are many places through which it enters.

The Blessed One declared:

When it has entered through the four channels,
the channels ache with heat,
the upper openings are uncomfortable and dust also arises.
One has a nature of torpor and sleep,
the color of the flesh is like froth,

and in dreams water and light appear.
After that, desire should be practiced.

When it has entered into the three sense faculties,
the senses are dazed and the body trembles,
the flesh is dry and the bones ache.
In that case desire should not be practiced.

When it enters through all the earthly sense faculties,
the pores of the hair turn red,
blotches and mottled flesh appear,
and in dreams animals arise.
It enters the king and the four channels.
At dawn one is displeased and speaks of clairvoyance.
Sleep is light, the nature of the body hair is white.
Black guggul resin should be relied upon.

The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi asked: What is the manner in which that illness is survivable and not survivable?

Vajrapāṇi declared:

One who has attained the signs of approach,
with the five nectars, spikenard,
the three fruits, and peacock flesh,
prepares pills and places them on the vertebrae.
Between these, if a peacock feather
has lustre, survival is certain.
If it has turned black, there is no survival.

The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi asked: Blessed One, there are many methods of cutting it off.

The Blessed One declared:

Mantra, mechanical device, medicine, and fire offering —
the methods are four in kind,
as declared by the awakening-vajra holder.
One who possesses empowerment and sacred commitment
and whose approach practice has become firm
should first repel it with mantra.
Through the king of mantras of the heart,

it arises accompanied by the wind.
Meditating on HŪṂ at the core of the illness,
by the assembly of causes and conditions it is burned away.
Then it should be repelled and suppressed.

The fire offering is explained as threefold:
the first is the pacifying fire offering —
round, one cubit across, white in color,
the opening four finger-widths, marked with a vajra;
triangular, ten finger-widths across, black in color,
the opening three finger-widths, marked with a vajra;
crescent-shaped, resembling a red moon,
half a cubit across, with an opening of that same form — so it is known.
The pacifying uses wood with milky sap;
the wrathful pierces it.

The enriching is the same as the pacifying.

A continuous fire in the home of an ill-omened lineage,
from the syllable RAṂ, the hearth is created and the fire deity invoked.
For pacifying, enriching, and magnetizing: the five nectars;
for the wrathful: red flesh, blood,
poison, black guggul resin,
and images — these are to be offered.

Homage to the supreme son of the lord of the world, Brahmā,
empowered by Ṭakki, king of the fire deity,
who burns all afflictions with supreme wisdom —
I bow in homage to the very fire deity who strikes with terror.

O fire deity of great splendor,
who grants all desires
and who is engaged in benefiting oneself and others —
I bow in homage to the supreme son of Brahmā.

The fierce one at the heart of fire
is to be invoked in accordance with the rite.
Through the connection with these fire offerings,
all wealth is bestowed.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One, the Vajra-holder:
What are the wrathful mantras?

Then the Vajra-holder spoke this mantra for taming all gods and demons:

Tadyathā: hūṃ phaṭ, nāga vidāraṇāya hūṃ phaṭ, nāga utsādanāya hūṃ phaṭ, nīlavasnāya hūṃ phaṭ, apratihatabalaprarākramāya hūṃ phaṭ, kṛtānatāya hūṃ phaṭ, kṛtāntarūpāya hūṃ phaṭ, roṣaṇāya hūṃ phaṭ, trāsanāya hūṃ phaṭ, kumbhāṇḍa utsādanāya hūṃ phaṭ, preta piśāca vināśakarāya hūṃ phaṭ, yakṣa apasmāra vināśakarāya hūṃ phaṭ, hasa hasa, dhara dhara, māraya māraya —

nāśaya nāśaya, sarvavighnavināśakarāya hūṃ phaṭ, sarvaśatrūṃsaṃvartavināśakarāya hūṃ phaṭ, nīlāmbaradhara vajrapāṇi rājñāpayati svāhā, oṃ vajra anala mahābhūta jvāla bhasmiṃ kuru svāhā, māraya hūṃ phaṭ, puṣṭi kuru oṃ.

By the mere utterance of these mantras,
all gods and demons are struck senseless.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi made this solemn declaration:

How wondrous! The buddhas of the three times
have conferred empowerment to tame the wrathful,
and by the utterance of this king of mantras they are made to tremble —
this marvel is supremely excellent.

Then each of them offered their life-essence to the Teacher and dwelt in the manner of servants. This is the third chapter of the Vajra Underground Tantra, the chapter on averting incurable disease.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi made offerings and prostrations to the Vajra-holder and presented this request:

Please teach the supreme maṇḍala
of body, speech, and mind.

Then the king, the Vajra-holder, spoke these words:

Without entering the maṇḍala
and without receiving empowerment,
even if one practices, nothing whatsoever will be accomplished.
Therefore let this now be explained.

Make it square with four sides and four gates,
furnished with four measuring lines,
divided into four great sections.
In the first great section to the east,

in the first of the four divisions is the center,
in the second, a lotus and a sword,
in the third, a divine banner.

Then the colors are to be laid out:
the center of the maṇḍala with its radiance,
a blue lotus and a blue sword,
a black divine banner and the vajra gateway —
these four are to be drawn in white.

Outside the gateway, draw the color black:
draw a blazing mountain of fire.
Encircle it with a vajra garland.
On the sixteen arrows and stakes
draw blue thread.

At the center, on the petals of the Blessed One's lotus,
draw a great nāga half-human in form with a serpent's head.
Once this is completed, the practitioner
should generate both according to the rite,
as taught in the tantra.

First, in the presence of the teacher,
perform the seven purified acts beginning with prostration.
Then cast flowers upon the wisdom being and offer praise.
After performing the seven purified acts of prostration and circumambulation,
invoke the descent of the wisdom being.
Contemplate the three syllables at the three places,
and recite this mantra:

āveśaya stambhaya rārā cālaya cālaya hūṃ āḥ oṃ jaḥ.

Then, having stabilized the maṇḍala, confer the empowerment of the vidyā
according to the rite.

Then grant the mantra authorization.

From the seed at the heart of the practitioner,
light from the mantra rouses the wisdom being.
From the tongue of the wisdom being, light arises
and is absorbed into the tongue of the vessel — so visualize.
Recite the auspicious words of the substances of accomplishment.

This is the fourth chapter of the Vajra Underground Tantra, the chapter on the
maṇḍala.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi made offerings and prostrations to the Vajra-holder and presented this request:

For the benefit of all essences
and for the sake of establishing beings in the Buddha's teaching,
please, O great Vajra-holder,
teach how to accomplish the yakṣa.

Then the Teacher, the Vajra-holder, for the benefit of all sentient beings, spoke these words on accomplishing the yakṣa:

One who reviles the vajra master,
or reviles the Great Vehicle,
or who deeply scorns its practice —
for such a one this accomplishment may be undertaken.

Regarding this: beneath Mount Meru there dwells a karmic yakṣa who has taken on a body with four faces and four arms. The first face recites the mantras of the Blessed One. The second face recites its own life-essence. From the third face comes breath of fire. In the fourth face there is profound flesh and blood. The method for accomplishing this will now be explained — listen well and hold it in mind.

Through the samādhi of the Vajra-holder —

After reciting the king of mantras one hundred thousand times, draw a maṇḍala of the four elements. Upon it, draw in thick blood a lotus of sixteen petals, fashioned in the manner of a prison cell. Place blue silk inside it. At the centre place human flesh and blood. Arranged circling from the right: first a dog, second a pig, third a copper-eared one with a topknot, fourth one that makes a sound, fifth a ra, sixth — ; seventh two births, eighth an ox. Arranged circling from the left: a mahé, a horse, a sheep, and a monkey. This is the samaya of the offering.

With blood, poison, and life-sinew, at midnight write the following on charnel-ground cloth: one with eight faces and a thousand hands, or ten; the first of the four faces is peaceful, the second is red, a makara; the third is a wrathful black, terrifying and fierce; the fourth has the head of a hungry ghost. The hair stands upward, matching the faces. The emanated father-forms are a vulture, a hawk, and a wolf — draw them with these as their heads. The hooking, inserting, and drawing in are to be performed as the power-command. This is the samaya of the instruction.

From the two samayas of approach, the three victories are to be known. Oṃ yakṣa ha sa ha sa da ra da ra hūṃ.

When hawks, wolves, jackals, dogs, and the like appear either in dream or in waking reality, then all the consecrated substances of the offering are to be mixed with the substance of the act to be accomplished, fashioned into an image, and inserted into a skull. On the dark night, make offering with the form of the yakṣa. Oṃ yakṣa māra ya māra ya. Apratihata bala parākramāya phaṭ. Sarva śātrūṃ saṃgha vināśakarāya phaṭ. Nīlāmbara dhara vajrapāṇi rājñāpayati māra ya cittala phaṭ.

If accomplishment has still not been achieved, then burn the image to ashes and perform a fire offering. Insert the image born of the act into a mound. If accomplishment has still not been achieved: Oṃ yakṣa māra ya māra ya nāra ya nāśa ya nāśa ya cittala rbad rbad. Pierce with the hand-vajra. If accomplishment has still not been achieved, recite Nīlāmbara sānāya phaṭ and meditate on emptiness.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, filled with wonder, made this deliberate proclamation:

Dwelling in inseparable union,
from yaṃ arises the wind, from paṃ the lotus —
this conceptual thought called "death"
shall pass on to Sukhāvatī.

This is the fifth chapter of the Vajra Lower Tantra: the chapter on accomplishing the yakṣa.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Vajra-holder with a request: How, O Vajra-holder, does one introduce a nāga into one that reviles the teacher from the heart? Please explain.

The Vajra-holder replied: The nāga has eleven diseases in its hands: leprosy, scrofula, kaṭama disease, kaśe disease, tumours, eruptions, emaciation, wasting, scabies, dropsy, and blockage. The nāga's realm is the seven subterranean levels. Nāga-servants exist even in Jambudvīpa. The retinue is fourfold: wearing clean garments and also consuming the three white substances, recite the king of mantras two hundred thousand times. Anoint the maṇḍala with sandalwood and saffron, draw an eight-petalled lotus, and depict upon it oneself as Vajrapāṇi surrounded by the eight great nāga kings. The rest has been explained.

To the west of the maṇḍala, construct an image of a nāga. The offering substances are the five precious things, or musk, or milk and so forth. First make offering to the deceased. Perform the inviting, the offering, and the praise in accordance with the ritual.

Meditating on a hūṃ at the nāga's heart, summon the great nāga from its dwelling by means of three rays of light. Dissolve it into the image, then make offering to it with offerings. When the image begins to move, insert it into the body of the enemy through the eight sense faculties. At the last fraction of eight —

With milk, musk, and sugar
straighten the path directly,
then by the practice of drawing down the clod,
insert the great nāga into him.

The practitioner should make use of guggul incense.

Apply a ritual dagger (kīla) to the image.

If even so it is not accomplished,

then, in accordance with the rite of the divine forms themselves, performing the ritual of removal —

tadyathā: hūṃ phaṭ nāga vidāraṇāya hūṃ, nāga vidāraṇāya, ha sa ha sa,
dhara dhara, māraya māraya, sarva śātrūṃ saṃgha vināśakarāya phaṭ,
nīlāmbara dhara vajrapāṇi rājñāpayati śātrūṃ citta māraya phaṭ, oṃ nāga
ghagha, ghātaya ghātaya, sarva duṣṭāna phaṭ, kīlaya kīlaya, hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ
vajra kīlaya, vajra daṃṣṭroḍ ājñāpayati nāga kāya vāk citta vajra kīlaya phaṭ,
nāga vidārāya phaṭ, nāga utsādanāya phaṭ, nīlāmbasanāya phaṭ.

By merely pronouncing this mantra, all sentient beings dwelling in the three realms trembled and fell into a faint. Then the Blessed One entered the meditative absorption called "Dispelling the Faint," and upon pronouncing the syllable Āveśa, all of them recovered their breath, came out of their faint, trembled, and with palms joined made this solemn declaration:

Empowered by all the buddhas,
destroyer of every harm —

by the power of this mantra and this absorption,
not even the buddhas can measure it.

This is the sixth chapter of the Vajra Lower Tantra, the chapter on the accomplishment of nāgas.

Now the narrative account is to be told. The Blessed One, the great Vajradhara, having gathered all tantras into eight divine modes of abiding, taught the Tantra that Tames the Three Worlds to the north of Mount Meru. Then, upon pronouncing the mantra of the three-faced, six-armed form, it reached the ears of the gods and asuras. Those vidyā-mantra holders were filled with wonder and offered praise.

Then, to the very heart of the continent, to the heart of the retinue — the yakṣa who holds the portion — the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi came and gathered all streams of the holy Dharma, like the essence of butter. He also taught eighty thousand tantra sections possessing the nature of the two activities of that same one.

Then, worshipped by the yakṣas of the world, the one who consumes flame-lamps was shattered, head severed from body, and ruined by the vajra. Thereupon, entering the meditative absorption called "Taming the Nāgas," he descended to the seven levels beneath the earth and taught the Vajra Subterranean Tantra.

This is the seventh chapter of the Vajra Lower Tantra, the narrative chapter.

The Vajra Lower Tantra is complete.

Translated by the Indian paṇḍita Dīpaṃkara and the Tibetan monk-translator Byai Gdong Pa Can.

Translator's Notes

- The nāga kings "Nandopananda" render the Tibetan "dga' bo dang nye dga' bo," which are the Tibetan equivalents of the Sanskrit nāga kings Nanda and Upananda. "Kulika" renders "rigs ldan," a standard Tibetan equivalent for the nāga king Kulika (Skt. Kulika or Takṣaka in some lists). These are standard nāga king names from the Buddhist tradition.

The phrase rendered "severing their own luminous appearances one by one before the Blessed One" (snang ba re re chad nas) is somewhat compressed; it suggests each nāga king's manifest form or aspect became an ornament of the Blessed One, consistent with a tantric motif of subjugation and transformation.

The final line is incomplete in the source text as presented; the translation preserves this incompleteness accordingly.

- The eight syllabic strings on the spokes of the wheel are transliterated phonetically from what appear to be corrupted or highly Tibetanized Sanskrit-derived seed syllables. Their precise Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain; they are rendered as transliteration rather than translation, which is standard practice for mantra strings of this kind.

The phrase rendered "three upper gates" most likely refers to the eyes, ears, and nostrils, or alternatively the nose, mouth, and ears — the exact referent is not fixed in the text itself and

may vary by commentarial tradition.

- The medical signs described in the passage appear to be symptoms indicating the degree of nāga-affliction in the body. The phrase rendered as "desire should be practiced" and "desire should not be practiced" likely refers to whether the performance of ritual propitiation or remedial practice is indicated or contraindicated, though a sexual or dietary interpretation cannot be entirely ruled out in context. The medical diagnostics here belong to a Tantric pathology framework in which nāga spirits cause illness by entering various bodily channels and sense organs.

The fire-deity addressed in the homage verses is Agni, the Vedic fire god incorporated into the Tantric ritual framework; "Ṭakki" as a name or epithet here is preserved from the Tibetan phonetic rendering and its referent is uncertain.

- The phrase rendered "seven purified acts beginning with prostration" refers to the standard sevenfold liturgy of prostration, offering, confession, rejoicing, requesting, supplication, and dedication common in tantric ritual manuals. The text lists prostration and circumambulation explicitly in the second occurrence and may be summarizing the full sevenfold practice.

The expression "vessels tongue" in the visualization sequence refers to the tongue of the eligible recipient into whom the wisdom being's blessing is absorbed — a standard tantric visualization of empowerment transmission.

- The mantras are rendered in phonetic transliteration as they appear in the Tibetan, without emendation; their Sanskrit syntax is irregular and may reflect Apabhraṃśa or corrupted transmission.

The phrase rendered "a copper-eared one with a topknot," "one that makes a sound," "ra," "a mahé," and "two births" in the circling arrangement all correspond to abbreviated or obscure animal or ritual designations in the Tibetan whose referents are uncertain. "Mahé" appears to be a transcription of a Sanskrit or non-Tibetan term for a specific animal, possibly buffalo.

The term rendered "rbad rbad" is a Tibetan onomatopoeic or ritual exclamation left untranslated as it is formulaic and has no semantic equivalent.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the final line, reflecting the source text ending mid-phrase at "at the last fraction of eight."

- The phrase rendered "the one who consumes flame-lamps" refers to Sgrön ma za ba, literally "the lamp-consumer," a yakṣa figure; the passage describes how this being was destroyed by the vajra as part of the mytho-narrative frame. The identity of this figure and the precise sequence of events in this cosmogonic narrative is somewhat obscure and the translation follows the straightforward grammatical reading.

The mantra passage is transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables; the Sanskrit reconstruction is approximate, as some syllables show irregular Tibetan orthographic conventions for Sanskrit, and nīlāmbasanāya in the final line may be a compressed form of nīlāmbarasanāya.

The translator's colophon name Byai Gdong Pa Can is an unusual Tibetan name meaning "one with a bird-face" and may be a rendering of a Sanskrit name; no certain identification has been established in the scholarly literature.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.